To clean or not to clean?

Colwin Way tackles the questions raised by reversing mounting work to clean up bases

COLWIN WAY

Colwin started turning aged 13 and has since gone on to teach the craft and wishes to continue to give people confidence to try the wonderful hobby for themselves. Colwin was born and grew up in Lyme Regis, a small seaside town in the southwest of England, and is still living in the area with his wife Vicki and two sons, Finley and Charlie.

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PHOTOGRAPHS BY COLWIN WAY

Reversing turning work to better deal with the recesses or spigots/tenons used initially to hold the piece poses more than a few questions. Do you need to? How would you do it? And what's the safest method? The answers will vary depending on your ability, the type of bowl you're trying to make, and your equipment. Here, I'm going to suggest some of the cheaper – and in some cases free – options available to reversing mounting work. As always, these are just a few types I commonly use and ones that work the best for me. There are numerous other methods of reversing, for example vacuum chucking, but these can be a little on the pricey side, especially for a beginner.

EQUIPMENT USED

6mm bowl gouge
10mm bowl gouge
20mm skew
3mm parting tool
Birch plywood
Steel rule
Square dividers
1 x roll of router matting
Bradawl
Faceplate ring
50mm sanding power pad
Contact adhesive
Shallow carving gouge
Pull saw

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